UX Report: Evaluation of SkillUP

Assignment: Group Design D
Team: Frame by Frame
Date: October 2026

1. What we tested

SkillUP is our prototype of an online course site for career skills. We tested the version we handed in for Design C. It covers the full path from finding a course to finishing its lessons. Our aim was to see where people get stuck before we build the final site.

2. How we tested

Five people took part on 9 October 2026. In this report they are P1 to P5. Each session followed our test plan. A group member read out each task without saying where to click. People thought aloud while they worked. We noted where they paused and what they said. The five tasks were:

1. Find a beginner course that helps with weekly reports.
2. Find out what the course covers and how long it takes.
3. Get as far as possible toward enrolling and check the total.
4. Find the course in the learning list.
5. Complete a lesson and check whether the progress changed.

Some sessions also asked people to sign up or log in.

After the tasks each person filled in the User Experience Questionnaire, or UEQ (Laugwitz, Held and Schrepp, 2008). It has 26 pairs of opposite words on a seven point scale. We present it in the short version called the UEQ-S. All eight of its items are part of the full UEQ. That let us report UEQ-S scores from the same answers (Schrepp, Hinderks and Thomaschewski, 2017).

Each answer becomes a score from -3 to +3. A mean above 0.8 counts as positive and a mean below -0.8 as negative (Schrepp, 2023). Anything in between is neutral. The UEQ handbook also gives a check for careless answers. It flags a person when two or three scales have very spread answers or when the same answer appears more than 15 times. P1 and P2 each had one spread out scale and nobody passed 15 identical answers. We kept all five answer sets.

3. Task results

Table 1 shows how each task went. “Done with trouble” means the person finished but hit a problem on the way.

Table 1: Task results per participant

Task	P1	P2	P3	P4
1. Find a course	Done	Done with trouble	Done	Done with trouble
2. Review the course	Done	Done	Not noted	Done with trouble
3. Check the order	Done	Done	Done with trouble	Done
4. Find it in My learning	Done	Done	Not noted	Done
5. Complete a lesson	Done with trouble	Done with trouble	Not noted	Done with trouble
Sign up or log in	Not tested	Done	Done with trouble	Done with trouble

Nobody failed a task. Every participant still met at least one problem. Most problems slowed people down or left them unsure about what had happened.

4. UEQ results

Table 2 and Figure 1 show the mean score for each scale. SD is the standard deviation, which shows how much people disagreed.

Table 2: UEQ and UEQ-S scores (n = 5)

Scale	Mean	SD	Result
UEQ scales			
Attractiveness	1.47	1.10	Positive
Perspicuity	1.40	0.88	Positive
Efficiency	1.75	0.73	Positive
Dependability	1.20	1.14	Positive
Stimulation	1.00	1.16	Positive
Novelty	-0.40	1.33	Neutral
UEQ-S			
Pragmatic quality	1.55	0.93	Positive
Hedonic quality	-0.05	1.08	Neutral
Overall	0.75	0.96	Neutral

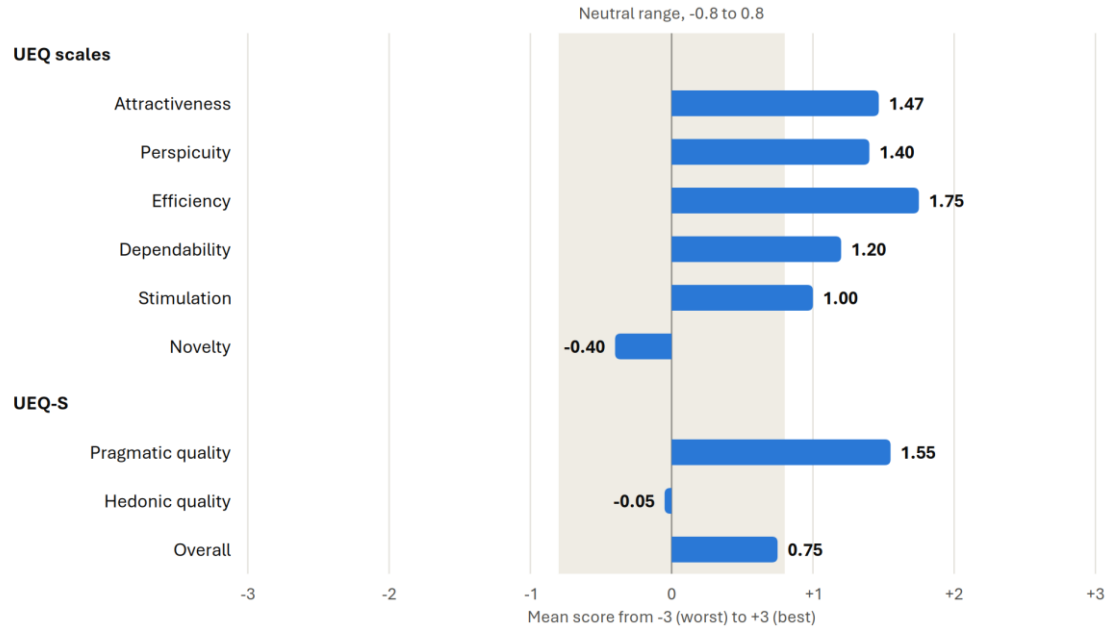


Figure 1: Mean scores on the -3 to +3 scale. The shaded band is the neutral range.

Table 3 shows the Lowest and highest items means. The three lowest items all belong to novelty.

Table 3: The lowest and highest single items

Item	Scale	Mean
Lowest		
usual to leading edge	Novelty	-1.00
conservative to innovative	Novelty	-0.80
conventional to inventive	Novelty	-0.60
boring to exciting	Stimulation	0.20
not secure to secure	Dependability	0.40
Highest		
cluttered to organized	Efficiency	2.00
slow to fast	Efficiency	1.80
unpleasant to pleasant	Attractiveness	1.80

Scores also differed a lot between people. P1 gave the highest overall UEQ-S score at 2.00. P5 gave the lowest at -0.25. With only five people these means are a rough guide.

5. Problems found

We rated each problem by how many people met it and how much it got in their way (Nielsen, 1994). High means it misleads people or puts their trust at risk. Medium means it slows people down or causes doubt. Low is a small issue or an idea for later.

Table 4: Problems found and the participants who met them

#	Problem	Seen with	Severity
1	Mark done and continue seems to do nothing	P1, P2	High
2	Checkout works without logging in	P1, P5	High
3	Logging out leaves the cart and progress behind	P3	High
4	The search button does nothing and longer searches find nothing	P2, P4	High
5	No certificate or review at the end of a course	P1, P5	High
6	Join SkillUP still shows after logging in	P3	Medium
7	Messages at the bottom right go unnoticed	P4	Medium
8	The course page looks finished before it is	P4	Medium
9	Filters and empty space push content down	P5	Medium
10	The celebration after paying feels flat and has no close button	P4	Medium
11	The steps to enrol are not clear	P3, P5	Medium
12	Sign up messages appear out of view	P4	Medium
13	Public code shows how the fake backend works	P5	Medium
14	The course level is hard to spot	P1	Low
15	No way to load more courses later	P2	Low
16	Dark mode looks less polished than light mode	P5	Medium

5.1 Mark done and continue seems to do nothing

Both P1 and P2 clicked Mark done and continue and thought nothing happened. P1 believed she had already reached the end. The button does load the next lesson but the page stays scrolled down near the button. We repeated the step on a 1366 by 768 laptop screen. The title of the new lesson ended up 353 pixels above the top of the screen. The only other sign was a small message in the bottom right corner. P4 said she never looks there. P2 also wanted the lesson list on the left to follow him down the page.

5.2 Paying and logging out feel unsafe

P1 noticed that she could pay without an account. P5 made the same point and said people should sign in first to feel safe. P3 found that logging out did not clear her data. We checked both problems. A visitor who is not logged in can reach the payment form. After logging out the cart and course progress stay on screen for the next person. This fits the low score on the secure item.

5.3 Search seems broken

P2 and P4 both tried the search bar first and then switched to the filters. We found two causes. The magnifying glass looks like a button but it is only an icon. Clicking it does nothing and only the Enter key starts a search. The search also looks for the whole phrase. A search for reports finds the course while beginner reports and report writing find nothing.

5.4 The course ends without a certificate

The screen at the end of a course says the certificate is on the learning page. No certificate exists there. P5 pointed out that it is never shown or handed out. P1 expected to review the course at some point and found nowhere to do it. The Peak-End Rule says the last moment shapes how people remember the whole experience (Kahneman et al., 1993). At the moment SkillUP ends on a promise it does not keep.

5.5 Medium and low problems

Most medium problems are about layout and feedback. On a laptop screen the catalogue shows no course until the user scrolls because the search box and filters fill the first screen. The course page has the opposite issue. A large empty area under the course details makes the page look finished. This is what confused P4. Figure 2 shows both.

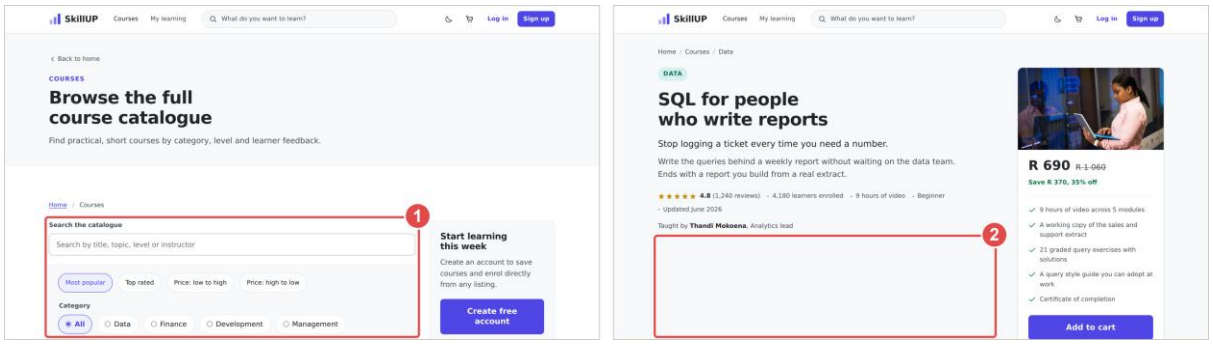


Figure 2: The catalogue (1) and a course page (2) as they first appear on a 1366 by 768 laptop screen.

P3 logged in a second time because the home page still showed Join SkillUP after she had signed in. P4 found the celebration after paying flat and could not see a way to close it. In the sign up popup the messages appear below the visible area. That explains why P4 felt the page gave no feedback.

P5 added a few more points. The footer sits too far down and the filters take up too much space. The site also lacks confirmation messages. Finally P5 warned that our public code shows how the fake backend works.

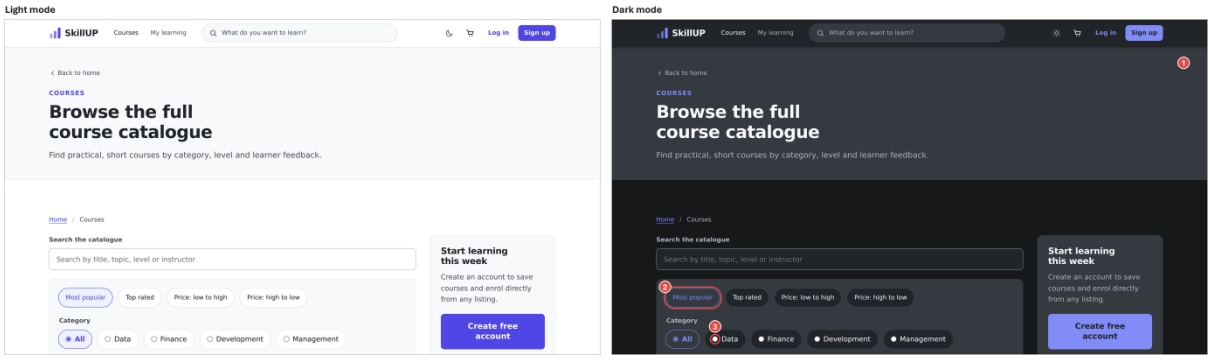


Figure 3: The course catalogue in light and dark mode on a 1366 by 768 laptop screen.

P5 also said light mode looks better than dark mode and that dark mode needs work on colour and contrast. Figure 3 shows why. Dark mode reuses the light layout with darker greys, which means the page loses the clean feel of light mode. The page header turns into a flat grey band above a near black page (1). Selected filters use a pale purple that looks washed out and measures only 3.86 to 1 against its background (2). WCAG asks for at least 4.5 to 1 (W3C, 2023). Unselected radio buttons and checkboxes also show as solid white dots. Which makes them look selected (3). The same parts look clear and balanced in light mode.

6. What worked well

Several parts of SkillUP worked well. Nobody failed a task. P1 said the design was clear and that each course was easy to tell apart. P2 said the layout gives enough information to decide. P3 found the small animations fun. Everyone who could not use search still found the right course with the filters. The UEQ backs this up with high scores for organized and fast.

7. Limitations

Five people are enough to find most usability problems (Nielsen, 2000). They are too few for exact UEQ scores and most scales had a standard deviation above 1. The sessions were also not identical. Some added a sign up task and a few tasks were not written down. One participant was our lecturer, who knows UX well and gave the most critical scores. An attractive design can also make people forgive problems and rate a site higher (University of Pretoria, 2026). P1 gave very high scores even though the Mark done button confused her.

8. Recommendations

Our UX design document explains each change in detail. In order of priority we plan to:

- Move to the top of the next lesson after Mark done and show the message there.
- Ask people to sign in before they pay and clear their data when they log out.
- Make the search button work and let search match single words.
- Give a real certificate and a chance to review at the end of a course.
- Show messages where people look and tighten the catalogue and course pages.

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